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Build Long-Running Processes with Workday Orchestrate

Orchestrate long-running processes with Workday Orchestrate by designing, building, and testing a single end-to-end flow that can suspend and resume as needed, execute complex steps asynchronously, and provide consistent logging across its entire lifecycle. This avoids fragmented handovers and separate log aggregation, saving time and money while maintaining full visibility.

In this activity, you'll create an orchestration that uses an Import API to load hundreds of applicants from an external recruiting system.

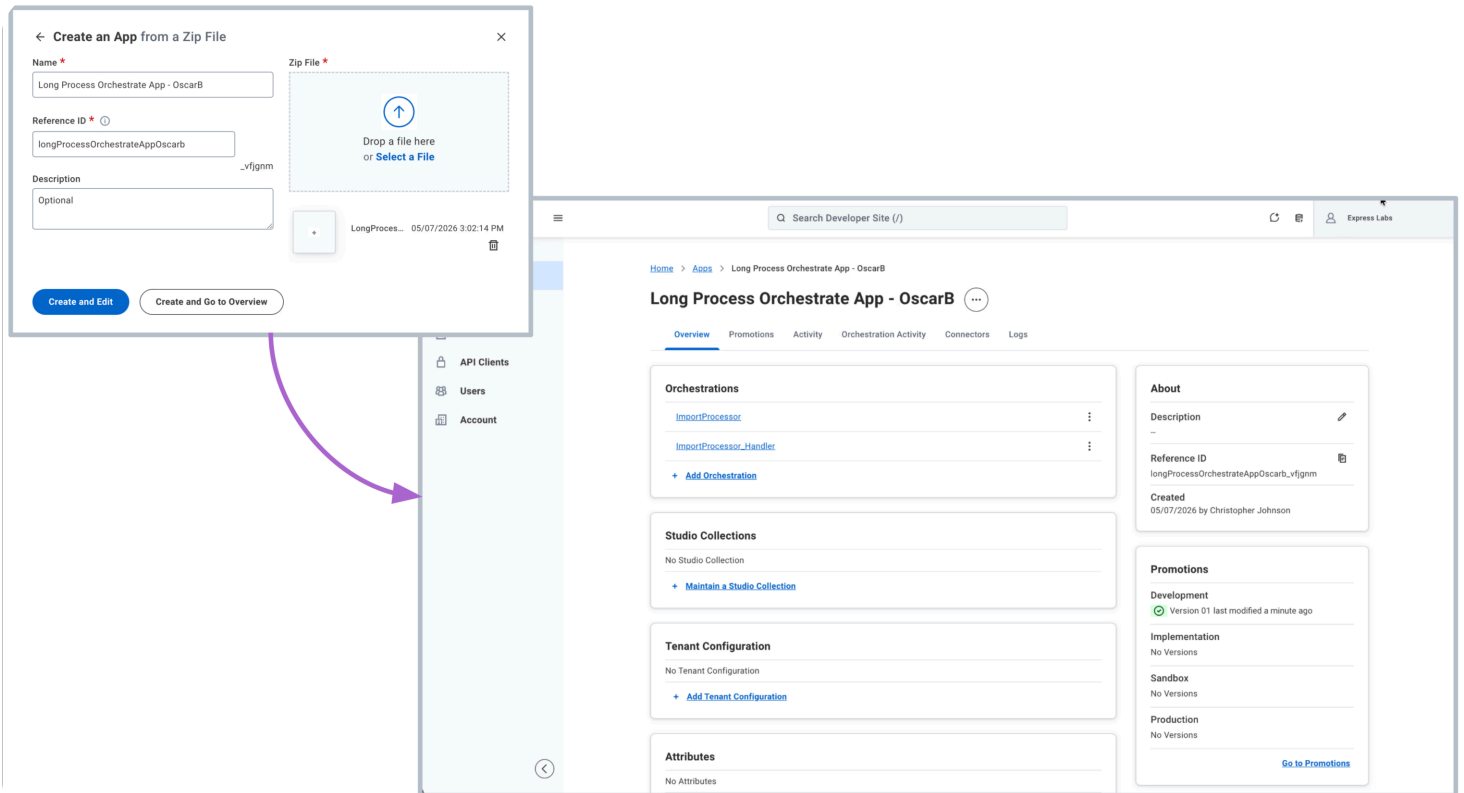
Task #1: Create an Integration App with Starter Code

To begin, create an Integration app with starter code. The starter code will save you time by providing a partially completed orchestration that you'll complete in this activity.

1. On your Express Lab laptop, select the browser tab for the [Workday Developer Site](#).
2. Select **Create an Integration App**.
3. Select **Upload a Zip File**.
4. In the Name field, enter *Long Process Orchestrate App - <your first name and initial of your last name>*. The Reference ID will populate automatically. Your name will help you distinguish your app from similarly named apps created by other DevCon 2026 attendees.

- On your computer's desktop, open the **04-Long Running Processes with Orchestrate** folder. Drag and drop the **LongProcessesOrchestrateStarterCode.zip** file into the Zip File field. Alternatively, choose **Select a File**, and upload the **LongProcessesOrchestrateStarterCode.zip** file.
- Select **Create and Go to Overview**.

✓ **Expected result:** On the App Overview page, you'll find that there are two orchestrations listed: **ImportProcessor** and the **ImportProcessor_Handler**.



Task 2: Configure the Trigger Integration Step

You are minutes away from a production deadline. Your lead developer has already built the logic to process 'One-Time Payments' in batches, but they were called away before they could hook the main processor to the sub-process handler.

The **ImportProcessor** (the parent) and the **ImportProcessor_Handler** (the child) are 90% ready. The data transformation is done, the XML logs are formatted, and the sample dataset is

loaded. However, the 'trigger' mechanism—the part that actually tells the parent integration to hand off data to the child—is missing.

You need to step in and perform the final 'wiring.' You will enable the batch loop, configure the trigger to call the child process, and aggregate the results. If you can connect these two pieces, the payment system goes live on time.

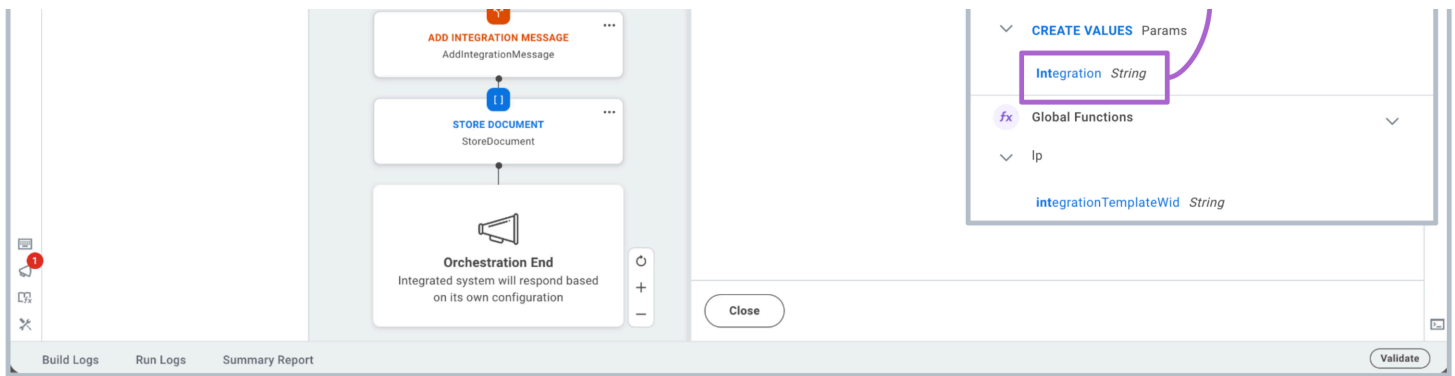
Set the Launch Parameters

1. Open the **ImportProcessor** orchestration.
2. Locate the BATCH LOOP named **TriggerBatchLoads**.
3. In the shaded box below the BATCH LOOP, select the **TRIGGER INTEGRATION** step. The orchestration steps in the shaded box of a BATCH LOOP step is executed for every batch that the BATCH LOOP processes.
4. Select the **Auth** tab and verify the Authentication is set to **Default Workday API Credential**.
5. Select the **Launch Parameters** tab.
6. In the integrationReference, select **CHANGE ME** and use the backspace key to delete it. Do not delete IntegrationReference, just the CHANGE ME placeholder value.
7. In the value: String field, select **+ Add new expression**, enter *int*, and from the dropdown list under CREATE VALUES Params, select **Integration String**. This sets the ID of the child integration system you will select in the Integration Attributes a bit later.

We always want to keep it close to the max possible duration of the child process but with a safe margin to avoid timeouts. In this activity we will keep it low, to show you how multiple processes interact together.

✅ **Expected result:** The integrationReference is the parameter that holds a reference to the specific Integration System instance you want to trigger. It is a **typed reference value** (data type: Integration System) that points to one particular integration system in your tenant. The Trigger Integration step uses this integrationReference to know **which integration system to start** when the step runs.

The screenshot displays the 'Long Process Orchestrate App - OscarB' interface. On the left, a sidebar shows 'Orchestrations' with 'ImportProcessor*' selected. The main canvas shows a flowchart with steps: 'CREATE TEXT TEMPLATE OneTimePayment', 'CONFIGURE AGGREGATION', 'BATCH LOOP TriggerBatchLoads', 'TRIGGER INTEGRATION LoadOneBatch' (highlighted with a purple box), and another 'CONFIGURE AGGREGATION'. The right panel, titled 'Trigger Integration', shows the 'Launch Parameters' tab. It includes a 'Reference Name' field set to 'LoadOneBatch'. Below, the 'Input Launch Parameter Values' section shows 'Child Integration' with 'integrationReference' selected and 'Params.Integration' chosen from a dropdown. A purple arrow points to this dropdown. At the bottom, a '+ Add string "int"' button is visible.



Define How the Document Will Be Stored

Next, you'll configure the Trigger Integration step's Document settings, which define the document that will be passed to the child process.

1. In the Trigger Integration step, select the **Document** tab.
2. In the Document to Store field, select the **+ Add new express** icon, enter *"batch"* to filter the list, and under BATCH LOOP TriggerBatchLoads, select **batch Xml**.
3. In the Document Title field, select **+ Add new Expression**, enter *data.xml*, and select **+ Add string "data.xml"**. The child orchestration will use the document tags we set later on to find the document.
4. Leave the **Description** field and the **Collection to Store Document In** fields empty.
5. In the Storage Expires In field:
 - Select **+ Add new expression**, enter *"zoned"*, scroll down the list to the **zoneddatetime** section, and select **now ZonedDateTime**.
 - Mouse over the **now** pill, select **fx**, enter *plus*, and select **plusDays**.
 - In the days: Number field, select **+**, enter *"1"* and select the **+ Add number 1**. (It should be cast as a number, not a string.)
6. The most important step is to select the right document tags, which will ensure that the child integration is able to find and pick up the file:
 - In the Tags field, select **+ Add new expression**, enter *stringlist*, and under the List section, select **stringList StringList**.
 - In between the brackets [], select **+ Add new expression**, enter *"doc"*, and under the CREATE VALUES Params section, select **DocumentTag**.
7. **Close** the properties panel and select **Deploy**. Your app will take a quick moment to build.
8. Select your tenant in the list (your tenant is shown on the card hanging from your big monitor), select **Deploy**, and if necessary, sign in to the tenant:

- Username: **Imcneil**

- Password: **Expresslabs2026fun!**

✅ **Expected result:** On the Document tab of the Trigger Integration step, configure the document that you want passed to the child integration, as shown in the image below.

Now that you've deployed your app and orchestration to the development tenant, you can connect it to the integration system that you'll create in the next task.

Trigger Integration

Editing

Reference Name * LoadOneBatch

Auth Launch Parameters **Document** Settings

Attach a Document to the Integration Event

Document to Store * TriggerBatchLoads.batch

Document Title * data.xml

Description

Collection to Store Document In

Collection will default to Integration System ID if not overwritten

Storage Expires In zoneddatetime now plusDays 1

Tags List stringList [Params.DocumentTag +]

Add "Retrieved" Workday Tag

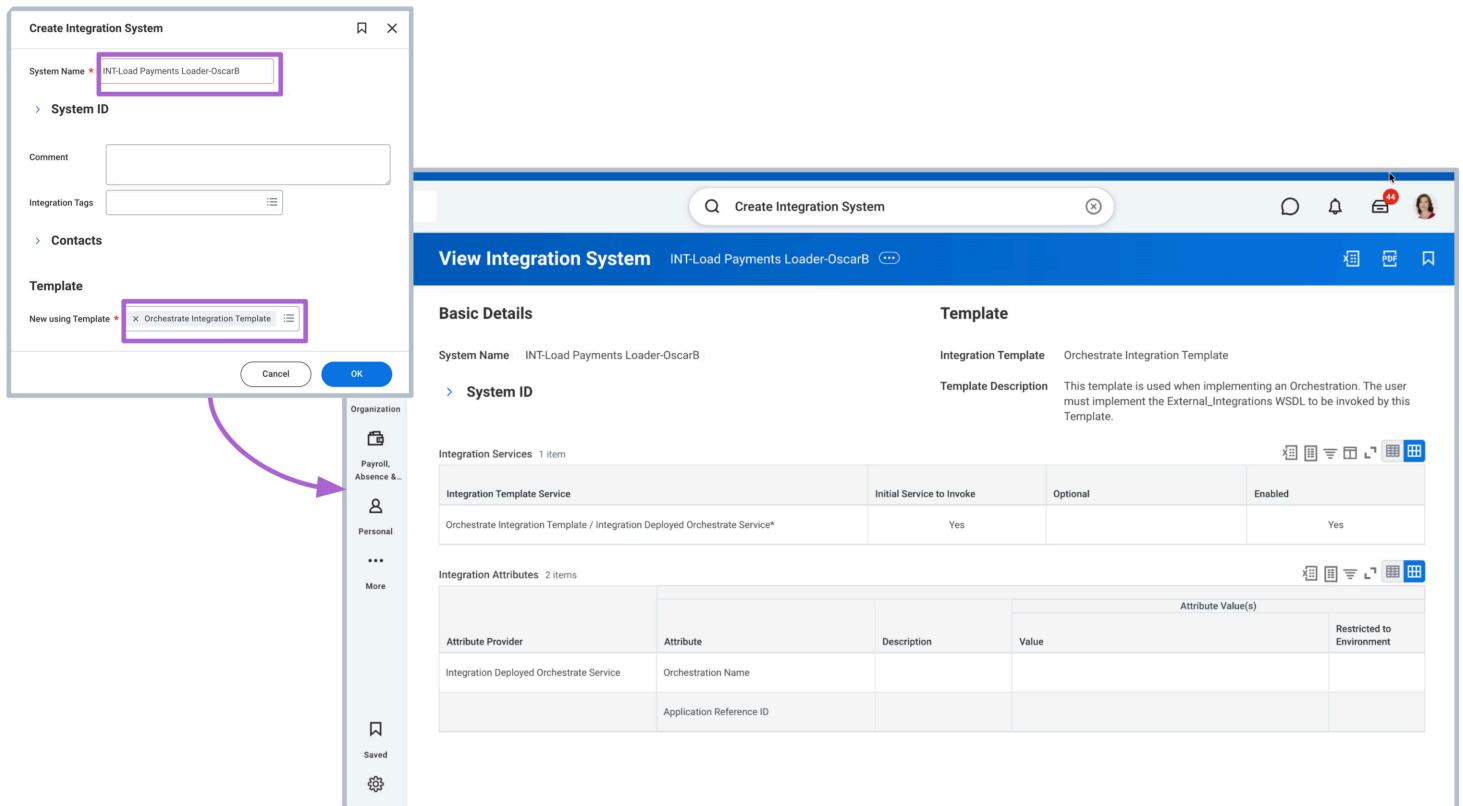
Close

Task 3: Create an Integration System in the Tenant

In this task, you'll create a new integration system in your tenant and connect it to your orchestration now that your Integration App has been installed to the tenant.

1. Select the browser tab where your development tenant is loaded.
2. In the Search box, enter *Create Integration System* and select the **Create Integration System** task.
3. In the System Name field, enter INT-Load Payments Loader-*<first name last name initial>*.
Important: Append your name or initials in order to distinguish your integration system from similar integrations created by your fellow conference attendees.
4. In the Template field, enter *orchestrate* and select **Enter**. This will select the Orchestrate Integration Template.
5. Select **OK**.

 **Expected result:** Create a integration system using the Orchestrate Integration Template.



The screenshot shows the 'Create Integration System' dialog box on the left and the 'View Integration System' page on the right. The dialog box has the following fields:

- System Name:** INT-Load Payments Loader-OscarB
- System ID:** (empty)
- Comment:** (empty)
- Integration Tags:** (empty)
- Contacts:** (empty)
- Template:** New using Template: X Orchestrate Integration Template

The 'View Integration System' page shows the following details:

- Basic Details:**
 - System Name: INT-Load Payments Loader-OscarB
 - System ID: (empty)
- Integration Services:** 1 item

Integration Template Service	Initial Service to Invoke	Optional	Enabled
Orchestrate Integration Template / Integration Deployed Orchestrate Service*	Yes		Yes
- Integration Attributes:** 2 items

Attribute Provider	Attribute	Description	Value	Restricted to Environment
Integration Deployed Orchestrate Service	Orchestration Name			
	Application Reference ID			

Task 4: Add Two Integration Attributes

When you configured the launch parameters in the Trigger Integration step, you set the `integrationReference` as the ID of the child integration system. In this task, you'll create the attributes points to the ID of the child integration system process and define the number of batches.

1. To the right of the integration system name, select the Related Actions menu and select **Integration System > Maintain Launch Parameters**.
2. Add an attribute to the Integration Attributes table:
 - In the Name column, enter *Integration to trigger*.
 - In the Attribute Type column, select **Data Type**, and in the Data Type field, search for *Integration System*, and you'll see a list of integration systems. Select the related actions menu and pick the version with the Description: **The integration system being launched**.
3. Select **+ Add Row** Use the + to add another attribute:
 - In the Name column, enter *Batch size*.
 - In the Attribute Type column, select **Data Type: Numeric**.
4. Select **OK**.

✅ **Expected result:** Create the Batch size and integration to trigger attributes, as shown below.

The screenshot shows the 'Maintain Integration Attributes' dialog box for the 'INTLoad Payments Loader-OscarB' integration. It contains a table with two attributes:

Attribute	Order	*Name	Description	*Attribute Type	Multi-Select	Option(s)
+	-	Batch size		☐ Enumeration ☒ Data Type x Numeric	☐	
+	-	Integration to trigger		☐ Enumeration ☒ Data Type x Integration System	☐	

A purple arrow points from the 'Integration System' option in the 'Data Type' dropdown of the 'Integration to trigger' row to a 'Report Field' dialog box. The 'Report Field' dialog box shows details for the 'Integration System' field:

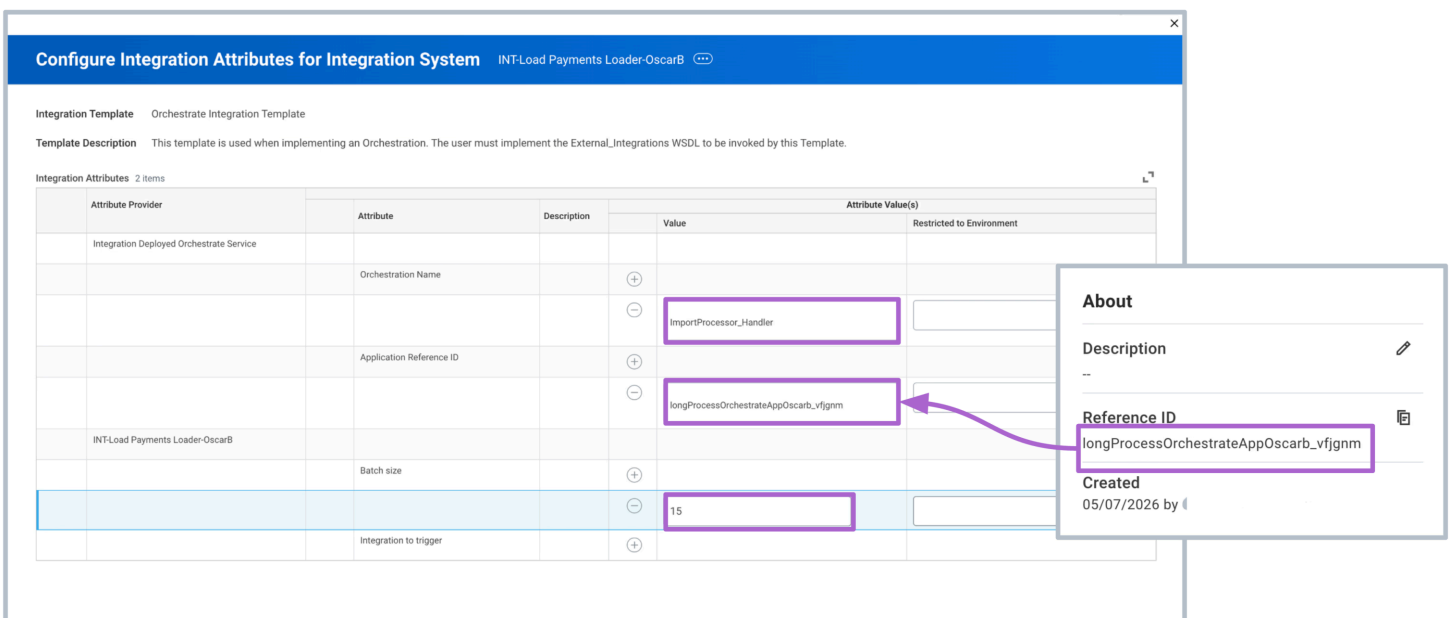
Report Field	
Integration System	
Field Name	Integration System
Business Object	Integration System
Description	The Integration System that is being launched.
Field Source	Workday Delivered
Field Type	Self referencing instance
Related Business Object	Integration System
Category	Integration
Authorized Usage	Default Areas
> Indexing Information	
WOL Alias	integrationSystem

Task 5: Configure the Integration Attributes

Integration attributes enable you to specify app-level, tenant-specific values that your integration system can access during run-time. In this task, you'll configure integration attributes that will enable the integration system to find the **ImportProcessor_Handler** orchestration, pass data to it, and run it.

1. At the top of the page, select the hyperlinked name of the integration system to return to the View Integration System page.
2. To the right of the integration system name, select **Related Actions > Integration System > Configure Integration Attributes**.
3. In the Value column that corresponds to the Orchestration Name attribute, select the plus + icon, and enter the name of your orchestration: **ImportProcessor_Handler**. The orchestration name is located above the **Components** panel in Orchestration Builder.
4. Select the plus + icon to the right of Application Reference ID. In the Value field, enter your Integration app's **Application Reference ID**. You'll find your app's Reference ID on the App Overview page in the About section. (See the image below.) Select the **Copy** icon next to the Reference ID to ensure you copy the entire ID.
5. In the row with Batch size, select **+ Add row** and enter any positive number between 5 and 20.
6. Select **OK**.

 **Expected result:** Connect the integration system to the **ImportProcessor_Handler** orchestration in your integration app. Copy the Application Reference ID from the App Overview page and paste it into the integration systems Application Reference ID field, as shown below.



Configure Integration Attributes for Integration System INT-Load Payments Loader-OscarB

Integration Template: Orchestrate Integration Template

Template Description: This template is used when implementing an Orchestration. The user must implement the External_Integrations WSDL to be invoked by this Template.

Integration Attributes: 2 items

Attribute Provider	Attribute	Description	Value	Attribute Value(s)	Restricted to Environment
Integration Deployed Orchestrate Service	Orchestration Name		+	ImportProcessor_Handler	
	Application Reference ID		+	longProcessOrchestrateAppOscarb_vfjgnm	
INT-Load Payments Loader-OscarB	Batch size		+	15	
	Integration to trigger		+		

About

Description

Reference ID: longProcessOrchestrateAppOscarb_vfjgnm

Created: 05/07/2026 by

OK

Cancel

Task #6: Run the Integration System and Examine the Results

In this task, you'll run the integration system and troubleshoot.

1. Select **Related Actions > Integration > Launch / Schedule**, and when the pop-window appears, select **OK**.
2. On the Schedule an Integration page, select **OK**.
3. Select **Refresh** until the Status changes to **Completed With Errors**. To find the culprit, we can check for integration messages.
4. Select the Output Files tab:
 - All files provided to the child integrations are visible with their name being import-data.xml (which may be a good change for later)
 - Each child integration created a log.txt which are all aggregated into all-logs.txt - you can review any of those files
5. Select the **Messages** tab. The Integration Messages from the parent and child processes appear here.
6. Review the **Child Processes** tab
 - All the child processes are listed there
 - If your Batch size was smaller than 27 there will be at least two processes there
 - One of the processes Completed with Errors - you can drill down by clicking on the link in the Request column to check the Output Files and Messages created by that process

How would you change the error handling of this process to better suit your business?

Congratulations!

You've created a scalable orchestration with Workday Orchestrate that can reliably process massive volumes of data — loading hundreds of applicants from an external system in batches, without manual intervention or fragmented logging. This same pattern can be applied to any high-volume data integration challenge your organization faces.

If you have a minute, we want your feedback. Please take the *short* survey on the next page.

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Tell Us What You Think

Please take a moment to share your feedback. Your responses help us improve future sessions.

1 Your Name and Organization

Write your answer...

2 Your email address

Write your answer...

3 The AI Widget feature is relevant to me and I'll recommend my colleagues that they use it.

Place yourself on the scale

1

2

3

4

5

1 - Strongly Disagree

3 - Neutral

5 - Strongly Agree

4 How can Workday better support you and your organization in driving innovation?

Write your answer...